

Word family: **confidence / confident / confidently / confide / confidant / confidential / confidentiality**

Base noun: confidence

Adjective: confident

Adverb: confidently

Related verb: confide

Related person noun: confidant

Related adjective: confidential

Related noun: confidentiality

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞) / related verb and noun forms (相關動詞及名詞)

Useful constructions/extensions: confidence in, self-confidence, have confidence, lose confidence, gain confidence, inspire confidence, confidence level, in confidence, vote of confidence, confident about, confident that, confide in, confidant, confidential information

Your passage contains:

> “What made her stand out was a combination of kindness, patience, and quiet **confidence**.”

Here, **confidence** means:

a calm, secure belief in oneself and one’s abilities.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **quiet confidence**

Mrs. Chan is not loud, boastful, or dominant.

Instead, she seems:

* self-assured;

* calm;

* secure in her ability;

* comfortable with who she is;

* able to guide others without needing to show off.

So **confidence** here means:

****a steady belief in your own ability, judgment, or worth.****

****繁體中文： ** 自信；對自己的能力、判斷或價值有穩定信心****

****中文翻譯： ****

> “a combination of kindness, patience, and quiet confidence”

「善良、耐性，以及一種****沉靜而穩定的自信****」

So:

****quiet confidence = 不張揚但穩定的自信****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****confidence = self-belief (自信) — 自信；信心****

This is the exact core meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “She had a kind of quiet ****confidence****.”

「她有一種沉靜的****自信****。」

Practice 2

> “Public speaking helped her build ****confidence****.”

「公開演講幫助她建立****自信****。」

Practice 3

> “He answered with confidence.”

「他很有****信心地****回答。」

****confidence = 對自己的能力、判斷或價值有穩定信念****

2. ****self-confidence (自信心) — 對自己的信心****

A major fixed compound.

Practice 4

> “Her **self-confidence** improved over time.”

「她的**自信心**隨時間提升了。」

Practice 5

> “Lack of self-confidence can stop people from speaking up.”

「缺乏**自信**可能令人大膽發言時有所顧慮。」

self-confidence = 對自己能力、判斷和價值的信任

3. **gain/build confidence** (建立自信) — 增強信心

Practice 6

> “Practice helped him **gain confidence**.”

「練習幫助他**建立信心**。」

Practice 7

> “She gradually built confidence in speaking English.”

「她逐漸建立了說英語的**信心**。」

gain/build confidence = 自信程度逐漸增加

4. **lose confidence** (失去信心) — 喪失信心

Practice 8

> “One bad experience made him **lose confidence**.”

「一次不好的經歷令他**失去信心**。」

Practice 9

> “She lost confidence in her ability to speak publicly.”

「她對自己的公開演講能力**失去了信心**。」

****lose confidence = 原本存在的信心下降或消失****

5. ****confidence in someone/something (對.....有信心) — 信任；信心****

A major separate branch.

****Meaning:**** Belief that someone or something is reliable, capable, or likely to succeed.

Practice 10

> “I have complete ****confidence in her****.”

「我對她有完全的****信心 / 信任****。」

Practice 11

> “The team has confidence in the plan.”

「團隊對這個計劃有****信心****。」

****confidence in X = 相信 X 可靠、有能力或會有好結果****

6. ****have confidence in someone (相信某人的能力) — 信任；信賴****

Practice 12

> “Her students had great ****confidence in her****.”

「她的學生非常****信任她的能力****。」

Practice 13

> “I have confidence in your judgment.”

「我對你的判斷有****信心****。」

****have confidence in someone = 相信某人的能力、判斷或可靠程度****

7. **confidence in a system/product/process (對制度 / 產品有信心) — 信任 ; 可靠感**

Practice 14

> “Consumers lost **confidence in the product**.”

「消費者對這件產品**失去了信心**。」

Practice 15

> “Public confidence in the system improved.”

「公眾對這套制度的**信任**有所提升。」

confidence in X = 相信某制度 / 產品 / 程序可靠有效

8. **confidence = certainty (確信 ; 把握) — 確定 ; 有把握**

A major abstract sense.

Practice 16

> “She spoke with **confidence** that the plan would work.”

「她很有**把握地**表示計劃會成功。」

Practice 17

> “There is growing confidence that the problem can be solved.”

「人們越來越**相信 / 有把握**這個問題可以解決。」

confidence = 對某件事是真的 / 會發生有較高程度的確定感

9. **confident = self-assured (自信的) — 有自信 ; 有把握**

The major adjective.

Practice 18

> “She seemed calm and **confident**.”

「她看起來冷靜而**自信**。」

Practice 19

> “He became more confident after several presentations.”

「做過幾次簡報後，他變得更加**有自信**。」

confident = 對自己的能力或判斷有信心的

10. **confident about something** (對某事有信心) — 有把握

Practice 20

> “I feel **confident about the interview**.”

「我對這次面試很**有信心**。」

Practice 21

> “She is confident about her decision.”

「她對自己的決定很**有把握**。」

confident about X = 對某件事情感到有把握 / 有信心

11. **confident that...** (確信.....) — 相信；有把握

Practice 22

> “I’m **confident that she will succeed**.”

「我**相信 / 有信心**她會成功。」

Practice 23

> “They are confident that the plan will work.”

「他們**有把握**這個計劃會奏效。」

****confident that = 相信某個命題很可能是真的 / 會發生****

12. ****confident in someone/something (對.....有信心) — 信賴****

Practice 24

> “She is ****confident in her team****.”

「她對自己的團隊****有信心****。」

Practice 25

> “He is confident in his own ability.”

「他對自己的能力****很有信心****。」

****confident in = 對某人 / 某能力 / 某事物可靠程度有信心****

13. ****confidently (自信地) — 有自信地 ; 有把握地****

A major adverb.

Practice 26

> “She spoke ****confidently**** in front of the class.”

「她在全班面前****自信地****發言。」

Practice 27

> “He answered the question confidently.”

「他****很有把握地****回答問題。」

****confidently = 以有信心、不猶豫的方式做某事****

14. ****confidence = trust placed in someone (信任) — 信任 ; 託付****

A more interpersonal branch.

Practice 28

> “She earned the **confidence of her students**.”

「她贏得了學生的**信任**。」

Practice 29

> “He betrayed my confidence.”

「他**辜負 / 背叛了我的信任**。」

someone's confidence = 某人對你所給予的信任

This moves closer to **trust** than self-belief.

15. **win/earn someone's confidence (贏得信任) — 取得信任**

Practice 30

> “It took time to **earn their confidence**.”

「要贏得他們的**信任**需要時間。」

Practice 31

> “Her honesty won the confidence of the team.”

「她的真誠贏得了團隊的**信任**。」

earn someone's confidence = 令別人逐漸相信你可靠、值得依賴

16. **betray someone's confidence (辜負信任 / 洩密) — 背叛信任**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 32

> “She told me something private, and I did not **betray her confidence**.”

「她告訴我一件私事，而我沒有**辜負她的信任 / 洩露秘密**。」

Practice 33

> “Sharing that information would betray his confidence.”

「分享那項資料會**辜負他的信任**。」

betray someone's confidence = 洩露別人私下告訴你的事情，或破壞其信任

17. **in confidence (私下地；保密地) — 私下；保密**

A major fixed expression and genuinely distinct use.

Practice 34

> “She told me the news **in confidence**.”

「她**私下 / 秘密地**告訴我這個消息。」

Practice 35

> “I’m telling you this in confidence.”

「我現在是**私下告訴你**這件事。」

in confidence = 告訴對方時相信內容不會被公開 / 轉告

This is not about self-confidence.

18. **take someone into your confidence (向某人透露私事) — 把某人當知己；告訴秘密**

A useful expression.

Practice 36

> “She **took me into her confidence**.”

「她開始**信任我，向我透露私事**。」

Practice 37

> “He rarely takes colleagues into his confidence.”

「他很少把同事當作可以**傾訴秘密的人**。」

****take someone into your confidence = 信任某人並與其分享私人 / 敏感事情****

19. ****confide in someone (向某人傾訴 / 吐露秘密) — 傾訴；信任地告知****

A major related verb.

Practice 38

> “She ****confided in her teacher****.”

「她向老師****傾訴了心事****。」

Practice 39

> “He ****confided in me about his worries****.”

「他向我****吐露了自己的擔憂****。」

****confide in someone = 因信任某人而告訴對方私人想法、憂慮或秘密****

20. ****confide something to someone (把秘密告訴某人) — 吐露；託付秘密****

Practice 40

> “She ****confided the secret to her friend****.”

「她把秘密****告訴了她信任的朋友****。」

Practice 41

> “He ****confided his fears to me****.”

「他向我****吐露了自己的恐懼****。」

****confide X to someone = 因信任而把私人 / 敏感資訊告訴某人****

21. ****confidant (知己；心腹) — 可以傾訴秘密的人****

A major person noun.

Practice 42

> “She became his closest **confidant**.”

「她成為他最親近的**知己 / 心腹**。」

Practice 43

> “He needed a trusted confidant.”

「他需要一位值得信任的**知己**。」

confidant = 你信任並能向其透露私人事情的人

22. **confidential (機密的 ; 保密的) — 機密 ; 不公開**

A major related adjective.

Practice 44

> “The information is **confidential**.”

「這些資料是**機密的**。」

Practice 45

> “Please keep this document confidential.”

「請把這份文件**保密**。」

confidential = 不應公開或向未獲授權的人透露的

23. **confidential information (機密資料) — 保密資訊**

Practice 46

> “Employees must protect **confidential information**.”

「員工必須保護**機密資訊**。」

Practice 47

> “The report contains confidential details.”

「這份報告包含**機密細節**。」

confidential information = 因私隱、商業、法律或安全原因需要限制分享的資料

24. **confidentiality (保密性 ; 保密義務) — 保密 ; 機密性**

A major related noun.

Practice 48

> “Doctors must respect patient **confidentiality**.”

「醫生必須尊重病人的**保密權 / 保密原則**。」

Practice 49

> “The agreement includes a confidentiality clause.”

「協議包含一項**保密條款**。」

confidentiality = 私人 / 敏感資訊不被未經允許公開的原則或狀態

25. **confidence = public/business/economic trust (市場 / 公眾信心) — 信心 ; 信任程度**

A major domain use.

Practice 50

> “Consumer **confidence** improved.”

「消費者**信心**有所改善。」

Practice 51

> “The announcement restored confidence in the company.”

「這項宣布恢復了人們對公司的**信心**。」

****confidence = 某群體對經濟、公司、制度或未來表現的整體信任程度****

26. ****consumer confidence (消費者信心) — 消費意願 / 經濟信心****

Practice 52

> “Low ****consumer confidence**** can reduce spending.”

「低迷的****消費者信心****可能減少消費。」

Practice 53

> “Consumer confidence rose this month.”

「本月****消費者信心****上升。」

****consumer confidence = 消費者對自身財務 / 經濟前景的樂觀與信任程度****

27. ****market/investor confidence (市場 / 投資者信心) — 市場信心****

Practice 54

> “The news damaged ****investor confidence****.”

「這則消息打擊了****投資者信心****。」

Practice 55

> “Stable results helped restore market confidence.”

「穩定的結果有助恢復****市場信心****。」

****market/investor confidence = 市場參與者對經濟、企業或資產前景的信任程度****

28. ****vote of confidence (信任投票 ; 支持表示) — 信任表決 / 肯定****

A major formal expression.

Practice 56

> “The government faced a **vote of confidence**.”

「政府面臨一次**信任投票**。」

Practice 57

> “The promotion was a vote of confidence in her abilities.”

「這次升職是對她能力的一種**肯定 / 信任表示**。」

vote of confidence = 正式表決支持某領導 / 政府；比喻亦可指明確表示信任

29. **no-confidence vote / vote of no confidence** (不信任投票) — 不信任表決

Practice 58

> “The parliament held a **vote of no confidence**.”

「國會進行了一次**不信任投票**。」

Practice 59

> “The motion of no confidence was debated.”

「**不信任動議**受到辯論。」

vote of no confidence = 正式表示對政府 / 領導層失去信任的表決

Recognition is useful for news/public-affairs English.

30. **confidence level** (信心水準) — 信心水平

A technical statistical use.

Practice 60

> “The survey uses a 95% **confidence level**.”

「這項調查使用 **95% 信心水準**。」

Practice 61

> “A higher confidence level usually requires a wider interval.”

「較高的**信心水準**通常需要較寬的區間。」

****confidence level = 統計推論中表示估計程序可靠程度的技術概念****

This is a domain meaning and should not be confused with personal confidence.

31. ****confidence interval (信賴區間) — 信賴區間****

A major statistical compound.

Practice 62

> “The result includes a 95% ****confidence interval****.”

「結果包含一個 ****95% 信賴區間****。」

Practice 63

> “The confidence interval is quite wide.”

「這個****信賴區間****相當寬。」

****confidence interval = 統計上用來表示參數估計不確定範圍的區間****

Learner-relevant in academic/statistical English.

**** Important distinction: confidence vs self-confidence****

confidence

can be broad:

- * confidence in yourself;
- * confidence in another person;
- * confidence in a plan;
- * certainty about an outcome.

self-confidence

specifically means:

> confidence in yourself.

Your passage's **quiet confidence** strongly suggests self-confidence, even though the word **self** is not stated.

Important distinction: confidence vs trust

These overlap but are not identical.

confidence

often emphasizes belief in:

- * ability;
- * reliability;
- * success.

trust

often emphasizes belief that someone is:

- * honest;
- * dependable;
- * safe.

Compare:

> “I have confidence in her ability.”

= 我相信她有能力。

> “I trust her with my secret.”

= 我相信她不會洩密。

Important distinction: confidence vs belief

belief

= accepting something as true.

confidence

= stronger sense of assurance/reliance.

> "I believe the plan might work."

can be tentative.

> "I have confidence in the plan."

suggests stronger trust in success.

Important distinction: **confidence vs certainty**

confidence

= high degree of belief/assurance.

certainty

= absence of doubt.

You can have confidence without being completely certain.

Important distinction: **confidence vs arrogance**

This is crucial.

confidence

= secure belief in your abilities without necessarily looking down on others.

arrogance

= exaggerated sense of superiority.

Your passage deliberately says:

> **quiet confidence**

which strongly suggests the opposite of arrogance.

Important distinction: **confidence vs pride**

confidence

= belief in ability/judgment.

pride

= satisfaction in yourself, achievements, or identity.

Someone can be confident without feeling proud about a specific achievement.

Important distinction: **confidence vs courage**

confidence

= belief that you can handle something.

courage

= willingness to face fear/difficulty even when confidence is low.

You can be scared but courageous.

Important distinction: **confidence vs competence**

confidence

= belief in your ability.

competence

= actual ability/skill.

A person can be:

> confident but not competent,

or:

> competent but not confident.

This distinction is especially useful for learners.

Important distinction: **confident vs sure**

confident

= strongly believing something will succeed/be true.

sure

= very certain.

They often overlap:

> "I'm confident she'll win."

> "I'm sure she'll win."

But **confident** often carries more sense of assessment/trust in ability.

Important distinction: **confident about vs confident in**

confident about X

= feel positive/sure about a situation or event.

> confident about the interview

confident in X

= trust someone's/something's ability or reliability.

> confident in my team

A useful collocational distinction.

Important distinction: **confidence in yourself vs confidence in someone else**

confidence in yourself

= self-belief.

confidence in another person

= trust in their ability/reliability.

Same noun, different target.

Important distinction: **with confidence vs confidently**

These are very close.

> “She answered **with confidence**.”

> “She answered **confidently**.”

Both mean:

> 她很有信心地回答。

The noun phrase can sound slightly more deliberate/emphatic.

Important distinction: **in confidence vs with confidence**

This is one of the biggest traps.

with confidence

= confidently / 有信心地.

in confidence

= privately / 保密地.

Compare:

> “She spoke **with confidence**.”

= 她自信地說話。

> “She told me ****in confidence****.”

= 她私下保密地告訴我。

Completely different meanings.

Important distinction: ****confidence vs confidentiality****

****confidence****

can mean:

> trust/self-belief/certainty.

****confidentiality****

= keeping private information secret.

Do not confuse them.

Important distinction: ****confident vs confidential****

A major vocabulary trap.

****confident****

= 有信心的。

****confidential****

= 機密的 / 保密的。

Compare:

> “I am confident.”

= 我有信心。

> “The report is confidential.”

= 報告是機密的。

Important distinction: **confidant vs confident**

Another major spelling trap.

confidant

= 知己 / 心腹; a trusted person.

confident

= 有自信的.

> “She is my confidant.”

= 她是我的知己。

> “She is confident.”

= 她很自信。

Important distinction: **confide vs confess**

confide

= privately tell someone something because you trust them.

confess

= admit something, especially wrongdoing, guilt, or a secret.

You can confide worries without having done anything wrong.

Important distinction: **confide in vs talk to**

talk to

= general conversation.

confide in

= share something personal/sensitive because of trust.

Much more intimate.

Important distinction: **confidence = self-belief vs confidence = public trust**

Compare:

> “She has a lot of confidence.”

= 她很有自信。

versus:

> “Public confidence has fallen.”

= 公眾信心 / 信任下降。

One is personal psychological state; the other is collective trust.

Important distinction: **consumer confidence vs consumer satisfaction**

consumer confidence

= optimism/trust about economic and personal financial conditions.

consumer satisfaction

= how pleased customers are with a product/service.

Different concepts.

Important distinction: **vote of confidence vs compliment**

vote of confidence

= concrete act showing trust/support.

compliment

= praise.

A promotion can be a vote of confidence even if nobody verbally praises you.

Important distinction: **confidence level vs confidence in yourself**

In statistics:

> **95% confidence level**

is a technical inferential concept.

It does **not** mean:

> “the researcher is 95% self-confident.”

Same word, completely different domain meaning.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **confidence** family is rich across self-belief, trust, certainty, secrecy, and technical domains:

- * **confidence — self-belief** = 自信 / 信心
- * **quiet confidence** = 沉靜、不張揚的自信
- * **self-confidence** = 自信心
- * **gain/build confidence** = 建立信心
- * **lose confidence** = 失去信心
- * **confidence in someone/something** = 對.....有信心 / 信任
- * **have confidence in** = 相信.....的能力 / 可靠程度
- * **confidence — certainty** = 確信 / 把握
- * **confident** = 有自信 / 有把握的
- * **confident about** = 對某件事情有信心
- * **confident in** = 對某人 / 能力有信心
- * **confident that** = 有把握相信.....
- * **confidently** = 自信地 / 有把握地
- * **earn someone's confidence** = 贏得信任
- * **betray someone's confidence** = 辜負信任 / 洩露秘密
- * **in confidence** = 私下 / 保密地
- * **take someone into your confidence** = 把某人當知己、向其透露私事
- * **confide in someone** = 向某人傾訴 / 吐露秘密
- * **confidant** = 知己 / 心腹

* **confidential** = 機密的 / 保密的
 * **confidentiality** = 保密性 / 保密義務
 * **consumer confidence** = 消費者信心
 * **market/investor confidence** = 市場 / 投資者信心
 * **vote of confidence** = 信任表決 / 肯定
 * **vote of no confidence** = 不信任表決
 * **confidence level** = 統計信心水準
 * **confidence interval** = 信賴區間

The main semantic branches are:

> **belief in your own ability**

> **trust in another person, system, or outcome**

> **degree of certainty**

> **private trust and secrecy**

plus technical extensions in:

> **economics, politics, and statistics**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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confidence — self-belief	對自己的能力、判斷或價值有穩定信念
quiet confidence	不張揚、不需要炫耀，但內在很穩定的自信
self-confidence	對自身能力、判斷和價值的信心
gain/build confidence	信心逐漸增加 / 建立
lose confidence	原有信心下降或消失
confidence in someone	相信某人的能力、判斷或可靠程度
confidence in something	相信某制度、計劃、產品等可靠 / 可能成功
confidence — certainty	對某件事是真的 / 會發生具有較高程度的把握
confident	對自己、某人或某結果具有信心 / 把握的
confidently	以有信心、不猶豫的方式
earn someone's confidence	令別人逐漸相信你可靠、值得依賴
betray someone's confidence	洩露別人私下告知的事情 / 破壞其信任
in confidence	在相信內容不會被公開的情況下私下告知
confide in someone	因信任而向某人透露私人思想、憂慮或秘密
confidant	值得信任、可向其傾訴私人事情的人
confidential	不應向未獲授權的人公開 / 透露的
confidentiality	私人 / 敏感資訊不被未經允許公開的原則或狀態

consumer confidence	消費者對經濟及自身財務前景的整體信心	
vote of confidence	正式或比喻上表示對某人 / 領導層信任與支持的行動	
confidence level	統計推論中的技術性信心水準概念	
confidence interval	統計上表示參數估計不確定範圍的區間	

For your original passage

> “What made her stand out was a combination of kindness, patience, and quiet ****confidence****.”

The exact meaning is:

****confidence = secure belief in one’s own ability and judgment****

But the adjective:

> ****quiet****

adds an important nuance.

Mrs. Chan’s confidence is not:

- > loud
- > boastful
- > attention-seeking
- > arrogant.

Instead, it is:

- > calm
- > secure
- > understated
- > steady.

So:

> ****quiet confidence****

= ****「不張揚但非常穩定的自信」****

This fits the rest of your description perfectly.

She:

- > had high standards

> but did not make students feel small;

> encouraged students

> without dominating them;

> trusted her own judgment

> without needing to show off.

Later, your passage says:

> “her influence ... shaped the way I see learning, **confidence**, and even character.”

There, **confidence** broadens slightly to mean:

> **the whole idea of believing in yourself and expressing yourself without needing perfection.**

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **have confidence**

> = 有自信 / 有信心

> **self-confidence**

> = 自信心

> **quiet confidence**

> = 沉靜、不張揚的自信

> **confidence in your ability**

> = 對自己能力有信心

> **confidence in someone else**

> = 對別人有信任 / 信心

> **gain confidence**

> = 建立信心

> **lose confidence**

> = 失去信心

> **be confident**

> = 有自信 / 有把握

> **confident about the interview**

> = 對面試有信心

> **confident in the team**

> = 對團隊有信心

> ****confident that it will work****

> = 有把握它會成功

> ****speak confidently****

> = 自信地說話

> ****tell someone in confidence****

> = 私下保密地告訴某人

> ****confide in someone****

> = 向某人傾訴

> ****a confidant****

> = 知己

> ****confidential information****

> = 機密資訊

> ****consumer confidence****

> = 消費者信心

> ****vote of confidence****

> = 信任表決 / 肯定

> ****confidence interval****

> = 信賴區間

So ****confidence**** is far richer than simply:

> ****confidence = 自信****

The key semantic map is:

****CONFIDENCE — self****

→ belief in your own ability

****CONFIDENCE — others/things****

→ trust in reliability or success

****CONFIDENCE — certainty****

→ degree of assurance

****CONFIDENCE — secrecy/trust****

→ in confidence / betray a confidence

****CONFIDE FAMILY****

→ confide

→ confidant

→ confidential

→ confidentiality

And in your original passage:

****confidence = “a calm, secure, understated belief in her own ability and judgment — strong enough to guide others without needing to dominate them.”****